UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2007

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **Maximum Number: 200**

MIEDIEVAL HISTORY

1. Where is the famous Vijaya Vittala temple having its 56 carved pillars emitting musical notes locates?

(a) Belur (b) Bhadrachalam
(c) Hampi (d) Srirangam

Ans. (c) : Vijaya Vittala temple is located at Hampi, the capital of Vijayanagar kingdom during the reign of Krishnadev Raya.

2. Who among the following wrote the book Bahubivah?

(a) Raja Rammohan Roy
(b) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(c) Pandita Ramabai
(d) Rabindranath Tagore

Ans. (b) : Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar wrote the book Bahubivah. It was written in protest of the evil of polygamy. Bahu (many or more than one)- bivah (marriage) meaning more than one marriage.

3. The First Factory Act restricting the working hours of women and children, and authorizing local governments to make necessary rules was adopted during whose time?

(a) Lord Lytton
(b) Lord Bentinck
(c) Lord Ripon
(d) Lord Canning

Ans. (c) : The First Factory Act was passed in 1881 during the time of Lord Ripon. It was passed to improve the service condition of the factory workers in India. It fixed the working hours for women and children above the age of seven years.

4. Consider the following statements:

1. Jawaharlal Nehru was in his fourth term as the Prime Minister of India at the time of this his death.
2. Jawaharlal Nehru was represented by Rae Bareli constituency as a Member of Parliament.
3. The first non-Congress Prime Minister of India assumed the Office in the year 1977.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 only
(c) 1 only (d) 1 and 3

Ans. (d) : Terms of Jawaharlal Nehru were 1947-52; 1952-57; 1957-62; 1962-64. He died in 1964 during his 4th Prime Ministerial term. He represented Phulpur constituency in UP. The first non-congress Prime Minister of India was Morarji Desai (Janta Party) from 1977-1979. Hence, statements 1 and 3 are correct.

5. Which one of the following was the first fort constructed by the British in India?

(a) Fort William (b) Fort St. George
(c) Fort St. David (d) Fort. St. Angelo

Ans. (b) : In 1639, Damarella Venkatappa, a feudatory of Vijayanagara ruler Venkata II, allowed the Englishman Francis Day to build a fort in Madras. This fort later came to be known as Fort St. George.

In 1698 AD, the British got the zamindari of Sutanati, Kalita and Govindpur in exchange for 1200 rupees. By combining these three, a fortified factory named Fort William was formed. Sir Charles Eyre became the first head of this Fort William.

6. Consider the following statements:

1. Robert Clive was the first Governor-General of Bengal.
2. William Bentinck was the first Governor-General of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) : Statement 1 is incorrect as Warren Hastings was the first governor-general of Bengal.

7. Who among the following Europeans were the last to come to pre-independence India as traders?

(a) Dutch (b) English
(c) French (d) Portuguese

Ans. (c) : Following the Portuguese, English, and Dutch, the French also established trading bases in India. Pondicherry on the Coromandel Coast was the first establishment of French power in south-eastern India in 1674 CE.

8. The ruler of which one of the following states as has removed from power by the British on the pretext of misgovernance?

(a) Awadh (b) Jhansi
(c) Nagpur (d) Satara

Ans. (a) : Lord Dalhousie took over Awadh in 1856 on charges of misgovernance. He merged Jhansi, Satara and Nagpur as well as Jaitpur, Sambalpur, Baghat, Udaipur, under the Doctrine of Lapse.

9. Who among the following started the newspaper Shome Prakash?

(a) Dayanand Saraswati
(b) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(c) Raja Rammohan Roy
(d) Surendranath Banerjee

Ans. (b) : Newspapers were an important medium for the dissemination of information on various problems. It is great help in the campaigns for social reform and to influence activities of the state. The first newspaper in India was the Bengal-Gazette started in 1780. Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar started Shome Prakash in 1890.

10. Who wrote the book- "The Story of the Integration of the Indian States"?

(a) B. N. Rau
(b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Krishna Menon
(d) V.P. Menon

Ans. (d) : V. P Menon authored a book on the political integration of India, "The Story of the Integration of Indian States" and on the partition of India, "Transfer of Power".

INDIAN NATIONAL MOVEMENT

11. Which one of the following places was associated with Acharya Vinoba Bhave's Bhoodan Movement at the beginning of the movement?

(a) Udaygiri (b) Rapur
(c) Pochampalli (d) Venkatagiri

Ans. (c) : Bhoodan Movement was a voluntary land reform movement in India started by Acharya Vinoba Bhave on April 18, 1951 started at Pochampalli village, in Telangana (Andhra Pradesh).

12. The song 'Amar Sonar Bangla' written during the Swadeshi Movement of India inspired the liberation struggle of Bangladesh and adopted as the National Anthem of Bangladesh. Who wrote this song?

(a) Rajni Kanta Sen
(b) Dwijendra Lal Roy
(c) Mukunda Das
(d) Rabindranath Tagore

Ans. (d) : The song Amar Sonar Bangla was written in 1905 by Rabindranath Tagore. He is the only person to write National Anthem of two countries. i.e., India and Bangladesh.

13. At which one of the following places did Mahatma Gandhi first start his Satyagraha in India?

(a) Ahmedabad (b) Bardoli
(c) Champaran (d) Kheda

Ans. (c) : Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa on January 9, 1915. In 1917, he started the first Satyagraha movement from Champaran. Gandhiji had gone there on the request of Rajkumar Shukla of Champaran.

After Champaran, Gandhi ended the dispute between the mill owners and workers in Ahmedabad and then led the peasant movement in Kheda.

14. Which one the following aroused a wave of popular indignation that led to the massacre by the British at Jallianwala Bagh?

(a) The Arms Act
(b) The Public Safety Act
(c) The Rowlatt Act
(d) The Vernacular Press Act

Ans. (c) : Jallianwala Bagh massacre took place on 13 April, 1919 during anti-Rowlatt agitation in Amritsar. Rowlatt Act was passed in March 1919 which authorized the government to imprison any person without trial and conviction in a court of law. Tagore renounced his Knighthood in protest against Jallianwala Bagh massacre.

15. Assertion (A) : According to the Wavell Plan, the number of Hindu and Muslim members in the Executive Council were to be equal.

Reason (R) : Wavell thought that this arrangement would have avoided the partition of India.

(a) Both A and B are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R all true, but R is not correct explanation of A
(c) A is true, but R is false
(d) A is false, but R is true

Ans. (c) : In October 1943, the British Government decided to replace Lord Linlithgow with Lord Wavell as the Viceroy of India. Right after assuming charge as Viceroy, Wavell's most important task was to present a formula for the solution of the Indian problem which was acceptable for both the Congress and the Muslim League.